TRI-STATE SALARY GUIDE 2027

HR & Operations salaries for 2027

What employers in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut are paying, so you can plan 2027 hiring with confidence.

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SALARIES BY ROLE

Base salary by role

Typical 2027 base salary in New York, by experience level. Individual roles show Early career (1 to 3 years), Experienced (4 to 6 years) and Senior (7+ years). Manager, director and executive roles show the lower range, typical pay and upper range, because their pay moves with company size and scope. New Jersey and Connecticut usually pay a little less; see Pay by location.

Role	Early career / Lower range	Experienced / Typical	Senior / Upper range
HR & TALENT ACQUISITION			
HR Coordinator	$66,000	**$68,000**	$95,000
Recruiter	$74,000	**$90,000**	$126,000
HR Generalist	$74,000	**$91,000**	$127,000
Human Resources Specialist	$74,000	**$92,000**	$111,000
Compensation Analyst	$83,000	**$98,000**	$116,000
Benefits Specialist	$76,000	**$95,000**	$113,000
HR Business Partner	$93,000	**$110,000**	$134,000
Director of Human Resources	$144,000	**$167,000**	$212,000
PROCUREMENT & PURCHASING			
Purchasing Manager	$95,000	**$117,000**	$138,000
Procurement Manager	$122,000	**$159,000**	$175,000
OPERATIONS & ADMINISTRATION			
Office Manager	$69,000	**$78,000**	$106,000
Commercial and Training Administrator	$68,000	**$85,000**	$102,000
Operations Analyst	$75,000	**$87,000**	$109,000
Executive Assistant to CEO & Office Administrator	$90,000	**$92,000**	$138,000
Operations Manager	$95,000	**$117,000**	$136,000
CUSTOMER SERVICE & SUPPORT			
Customer Service Representative	$51,000	**$64,000**	$76,000
Account Coordinator	$51,000	**$64,000**	$70,000

PAY BY INDUSTRY AND LOCATION

Where pay runs higher or lower

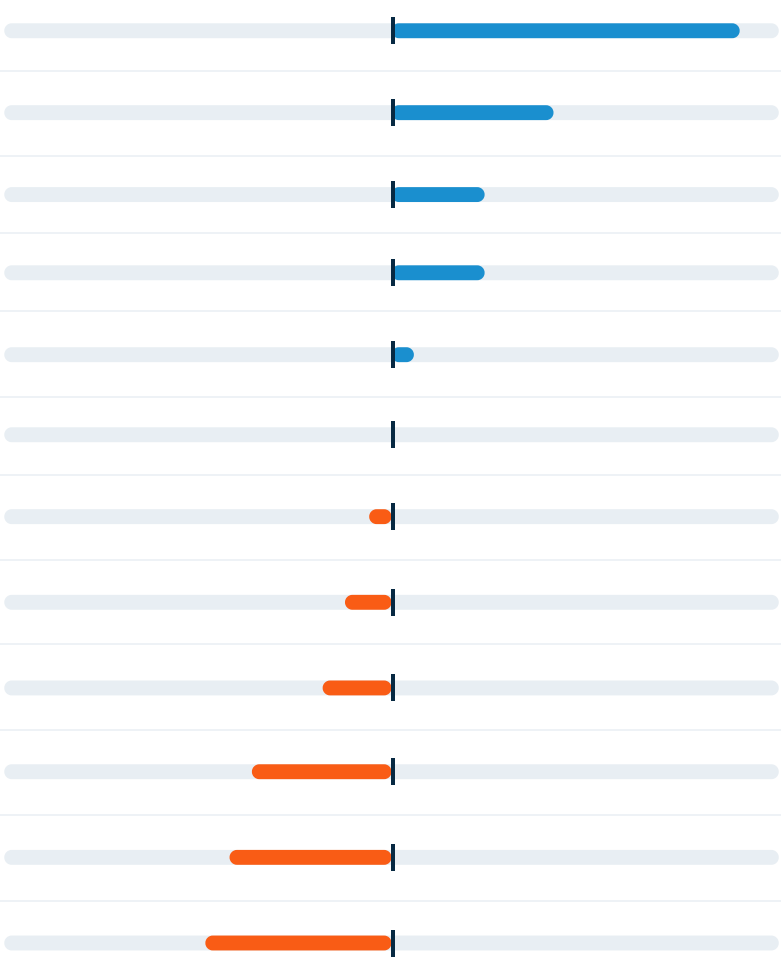
Each figure compares base salary in job postings from the last six months with the tri-state market for the same roles. The example shows what a $100,000 role would pay.

By location



New York City	**5% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $105,000
Long Island	**In line with market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Westchester and Hudson Valley	**4% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $96,000
New Jersey	**5% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $95,000
Connecticut	**5% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $95,000

By industry



Fintech	**15% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $115,000
Hedge funds and asset management	**7% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $107,000
Technology	**4% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $104,000
Professional services	**4% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $104,000
Banking and capital markets	**1% above market**	$100,000 role ≈ $101,000
Insurance	**In line with market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Manufacturing and industrial	**1% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $100,000
Healthcare and life sciences	**2% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $98,000
Consumer, retail and hospitality	**3% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $97,000
Real estate and construction	**6% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $94,000
Media, entertainment and sports	**7% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $93,000
Nonprofit, education and government	**8% below market**	$100,000 role ≈ $92,000

BONUS AND EQUITY

What employers pay on top of salary

Almost every company has a bonus plan

Share of companies with a yearly bonus plan (short-term incentive) for at least some employees. Not every role is eligible.



Equity plans are standard at public companies

Share of companies with an equity or multi-year cash plan (long-term incentive) for at least some employees



Public companies are twice as likely to give managers equity

Share of companies that give managers a long-term incentive



How bonuses are structured

ANNUAL BONUS

Almost every for-profit employer has a bonus plan.

Nearly universal at for-profit companies: 98% of public and 93% of private companies pay short-term incentives

OTHER CASH AWARDS

Spot, discretionary and retention bonuses fill the gaps.

Annual plans come first, with spot awards, discretionary bonuses and retention bonuses added for flexibility

EXECUTIVE TARGETS

Public companies set bigger executive bonus targets.

Public-company CEO target bonuses average 128% of salary, against 100% at private companies. The gap largely disappears at the professional level and below

How equity is structured

MANAGERS

Public companies are twice as likely to give managers equity.

50% of public companies give managers long-term incentives, compared with 25% of private companies

PROFESSIONALS

Most equity for professionals is earned just by staying.

When salaried professionals get equity, 72% of awards vest on time alone; for managers it is 65%

NONPROFITS

Nonprofits pay bonuses less often and rarely offer equity.

Only 66% of nonprofits pay short-term incentives and 26% offer long-term incentives

Building your offer

- Many support and admin roles have no bonus plan. A spot-award or retention-bonus program is a low-cost way to compete.
- For HR and operations leaders, equity is the biggest gap between public and private employers. If you cannot offer it, a multi-year cash incentive can stand in.
- Spell out bonus eligibility in the offer. Candidates for operations roles often assume there is none.

What leaders can expect on top of salary

Director of HR	A cash bonus is the norm; equity mostly comes at public companies or once the role reaches VP or the C-suite.
Chief HR Officer	At large public companies stock is the biggest part of pay. At private companies expect a larger cash bonus and, at PE-backed ones, a share of the company.
Payroll Director	Plan on a cash bonus. Equity is uncommon outside public companies.

PERKS AND BENEFITS

Perks that win offers

How common each perk is, and which ones set you apart.

57%

FLEXIBILITY

Hybrid is getting rarer, so it stands out more

SHRM's 2026 Employee Benefits Survey found 57% of employers offer hybrid work, down from 63%. Offering it is becoming a point of difference.

27%

FLEXIBILITY

Try a work-from-anywhere window

SHRM reported 27% of employers began offering limited-time work-from-anywhere arrangements in 2026, a lower-commitment way to add flexibility.

30%

FLEXIBILITY

A four-day week is the top return-to-office incentive

In FlexJobs' survey, 30% of workers named a four-day workweek as the perk that would persuade them to return to the office full time, ahead of a raise of 15% or more (18%).

46%

FAMILY

Paid parental leave is spreading fast

SHRM's 2026 survey of 5,472 organizations found 46% now offer paid parental leave, up seven points in a year. Paid prenatal leave beyond legal requirements rose from 10% to 18%.

50%

FAMILY

Fertility and family-building coverage

Mercer found IVF coverage is now offered by 50% of large employers, and by 77% of those with 20,000 or more employees.

81%

MONEY

The 401(k) match is expected

SHRM's 2026 survey found 90% of employers offer a traditional 401(k) and 81% of them match contributions. The average maximum match is 6.11%.

10%

MONEY

Student loan help is still rare

SHRM found company-provided student loan repayment grew from 8% to 10% of employers, with the average tuition or loan repayment maximum rising to $5,546. A rare benefit is a memorable one.

33%

GROWTH

Paid AI tools are the fastest-growing perk

Employer-sponsored AI tool subscriptions jumped 17 percentage points to 33% of employers in SHRM's 2026 survey.

49%

HEALTH

Weight-loss drug coverage divides employers

Mercer found 49% of large employers covered GLP-1 drugs for weight loss, though 6% dropped coverage in 2026. Across employers of all sizes, SHRM found only 15% cover them for weight management.

2027 OUTLOOK

HR & Operations hiring in 2027

The numbers that matter for 2027 hiring.

In demand for 2027

3.1%

AI skills are showing up in HR postings

SHRM's analysis of job postings found 3.1% of HR postings highlighted AI and machine learning skills by December 2025, compared with 2.3% across all jobs.

29.6%

Admin-heavy HR roles are shrinking

AIHR's HR Trends 2027 report found demand for HR administrators fell 29.6% and for HR service desk agents 38.3%, as routine HR work moves to technology. Strategic and advisory HR roles are where hiring is shifting.

6%

Business partners, compensation and learning lead HR demand

Addison Group's 2026 Workforce Planning Guide lists HR director, HR manager, HR generalist, learning and development manager and compensation analyst among the most in-demand HR roles, citing projected 6% growth in HR roles over the next decade.

11%

Procurement talent that can use AI is scarce

DSJ Global's 2026 procurement hiring research, citing the 2026 ProcureCon CPO Report, notes only 11% of procurement leaders feel fully ready to use AI across their operations, which makes professionals who can bridge that gap among the hardest to hire.

Where employers are investing

46%

Procurement is upskilling rather than adding headcount

ProcureAbility's 2026 CPO Benchmark found 46% of procurement teams are investing in upskilling current staff, while only 19% are adding headcount.

CPOs are behind on redesigning roles for AI

Gartner's 2026 Chief Procurement Officer Survey of 213 senior procurement leaders warns that leaders who delay redesigning procurement roles for AI risk leaving their teams without the talent to capture its value.

HR is redesigning its operating model

AIHR's HR Priorities 2027 sets five priorities for HR leaders, including redesigning work for human and AI performance and redesigning HR's own operating model for human-AI delivery.

Employers are adding leave and AI tools to benefits

SHRM's 2026 Employee Benefits Survey, based on 5,472 HR responses, found employers expanding parental leave and AI-tool subscriptions as benefits.

What happened in 2026

72%

Workers expect more from employers

SHRM's 2026 State of the Workplace survey of more than 1,800 HR professionals and 2,000 workers found 72% of HR respondents say workers have higher expectations of employers than in the past. Workers ranked pay, stress and burnout, and work-life integration as their top needs.

46%

Leadership development is the top CHRO focus

SHRM's 2026 CHRO Priorities and Perspectives survey of 129 chief HR officers found leadership development was the top focus for the second year running, cited by 46%.

64%

HR hiring is holding steady

In HR Brew's June 2026 survey of more than 200 people professionals, 64% said their hiring outlook for the second half of 2026 matched the first half, and 16% expected to hire more.

61%

Procurement teams are asked for more savings

ProcureAbility's 2026 CPO Benchmark found 61% of procurement leaders said savings targets rose in 2026 versus 2025. Only 19% are adding headcount; 46% are upskilling the staff they have.

What 2027 looks like

3.2%

Merit budgets hold steady

Mercer's July 2026 QuickPulse survey of 1,001 US employers projects 3.5% total increase budgets and 3.2% merit budgets for 2027.

3.4%

Budgets are flat to slightly lower

WTW's survey of 1,650 US organizations projects 3.4% salary increase budgets for 2027, versus 3.5% actual in 2026.

36%

Overall hiring intent is solid

ManpowerGroup's US Net Employment Outlook for Q4 2026 is 36%. The Q1 2027 survey had not been released as of this guide's research date.

36%

Small firms still can't fill jobs

In October 2026, 36% of small-business owners had openings they could not fill. A net 24% plan to raise compensation in the next three months, up 4 points.

What managers need to know

39 days

Plan for about six weeks to fill a role

SHRM's 2026 benchmarking data shows a median time-to-fill of 39 calendar days for nonexecutive positions, down from last year. Executive cost-per-hire rose substantially.

Yearly

AI screening tools in NYC need a bias audit

NYC Local Law 144 requires an annual independent bias audit, a posted audit summary and candidate notice before using automated hiring tools. A December 2025 state audit pushed NYC to tighten enforcement.

Dec 15

New Jersey targets biased hiring algorithms

New Jersey disparate-impact rules effective December 15, 2025 name automated decision-making tools as a source of liability. Employers should be able to show how they tested screening tools for bias.

Oct 1

Connecticut now requires pay ranges in postings

From October 1, 2026, Connecticut employers of any size must post a good-faith wage range and a benefits description. This also covers remote roles reporting to a Connecticut supervisor or worksite.

10+

New Jersey requires pay ranges too

Since June 1, 2025, New Jersey employers with 10 or more employees must list pay or a pay range and a benefits summary on postings. Penalties are $300 for a first violation and $600 after.

Off limits

Don't ask about pay history

Connecticut bars employers from asking about wage history unless the applicant volunteers it. Its October 2026 law also requires pay ranges on internal postings, not just external ones.

$66,300

Know the exempt salary floor

In 2026, executive and administrative employees in NYC, Long Island and Westchester must earn at least $1,275 a week ($66,300 a year) to be exempt. Elsewhere in New York, the floor is $1,199.10.

$17.00

Minimum wage pauses on January 1

The NYC, Long Island and Westchester minimum wage stays $17.00 on January 1, 2027. The Governor proposed $17.60 from March 1, 2027, if the Legislature approves.

3 states

Noncompete bans are stalled, for now

As of April 2026, bills to restrict noncompetes in New York (S4641), New Jersey (S1407/A1829) and Connecticut (Raised Bill 5492) were pending. New York's bill would exempt earners of $500,000 or more.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Where the numbers come from

Sources

- Vaco by Highspring internal data.
- Current data only. Every figure was published or collected in 2026. The one exception is the U.S. Dept. of Labor wage survey, whose latest release covers May 2025.
- U.S. Dept. of Labor (BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics, May 2025): New York-Newark-Jersey City metro, plus New Jersey and Connecticut statewide.
- Job postings with posted salary ranges in New York, New Jersey and Connecticut, posted in the last six months (May 10 to November 10, 2026), from Google Jobs, company career sites and job boards.
- Salary sites: Glassdoor, PayScale, Salary.com, ZipRecruiter, Built In, Comparably and Levels.fyi, New York figures, collected November 2026.
- Bonus and long-term incentives: SEC proxy filings of public companies headquartered in the New York area, and published executive pay surveys.
- Total pay with bonus: Glassdoor and PayScale New York pages that publish both base and total pay, compared page by page.
- Perks and benefits:
- Market outlook:

How the numbers are set

- Vaco by Highspring adjustment. Pay figures are adjusted using Vaco by Highspring's recruiting experience in the New York, New Jersey and Connecticut market.
- Vaco recommended offer (in each role card and the hiring advisor): about the 65th percentile, the typical figure plus 60% of the way to the upper end. It is Vaco's advice on what it takes to win a strong candidate, not a market average.
- Vaco by Highspring internal data counts twice and is never dropped as an outlier.
- Each source counts once, except Vaco internal data. The typical salary is the middle of the sources' typical figures; the range is the middle of their low and high figures (25th and 75th percentiles where published).
- Accounting and finance titles: Early career is the staff or analyst title, Experienced is the senior title (the 4 to 6 year job), Senior is the upper end of the senior title.
- Outlier rule: any source figure more than 15% below or 35% above the middle of all sources for that role is left out, so one site that reads far off the rest cannot pull a role down or up.
- Where a senior title was combined into its base role, the Experienced figure sits between the two titles, because senior is a matter of years, not a different job.
- Job postings: the middle of posted low and high ends, and of the midpoints. Duplicates, hourly and contract roles, and postings older than six months are excluded.
- Financial Services figures use postings from banks, insurers, investment firms and private equity, plus Vaco internal data. Accounting & Finance figures exclude those employers.
- New Jersey and Connecticut are compared with New York source by source: each source's state figure is set against the same source's New York figure for that role, and the typical gap is applied to the New York pay. Where a role has fewer than two matching sources, the state's typical gap to New York is used. A state is shown above New York only when the matching sources support it.
- Industry views use real pay data. Where a role has no figure of its own for an industry (fewer than 3 postings), it is scaled by how that industry pays for roles in the same skill area (8 or more postings), or else by how it pays across all roles.
- Base annual salary unless stated. Bonus and equity figures are shown separately, with their sources.

TALK TO US

Want help pricing a role?

Talk to your local Vaco team for role-specific data, who is available to hire now, and help building an offer that wins.

vaco.com/contact-us

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